

DESIGN BRIEF

GALACTIC CHESS INVADERS · NEON-VECTOR RECHARGED

macOS · SpriteKit
48 years in the making

An arcade-chess hybrid: a real chess game plays out while Black's pieces double as a **Space Invaders fleet** — sliding, descending and firing — and the player commands White's moves and a laser ship at once. The look fuses the original 1983 Apple II demo and golden-age arcade (Space Invaders, Galaxian) with the modern Atari **"Recharged"** aesthetic — a neon light-show in deep space.

APPROACH

VECTOR, NOT PIXELS — smooth glowing outlines, zero staircased pixel art.

BLOOM AT RUNTIME — clean line art; glow added live via SKEffectNode.

PURE-BLACK VOID — pieces float; no board grid; parallax starfield + nebula.

OUTLINE-FORWARD — empty interiors, bright edges, white-hot cores.

ARCADE FX — dash-spark debris, fireball blasts, capsule laser trails.

COLOR PALETTE

 #000000 Void	 #12E8FF Player	 #FF2060 Enemy	 #7DFF4D Scout	 #FFBA1E Escort	 #3AA2FF Flagship
---	---	--	--	---	---

TYPEFACES

PRESS START 2P

Display · titles · HUD · scores

THE 1983 ORIGINAL · APPLE II



TASC compiled BASIC · monochrome green CRT

RECHARGED



same DNA · vector outlines + neon bloom

GALACTIC CHESS INVADERS

. 40 YEARS IN THE MAKING .



PRESS ANY KEY TO START

HIGH SCORES

1	ZUL	052300	L8
2	CPU	041750	L7
3	ACE	033400	L6
4	AY2	028900	L5
5	BOT	019250	L4

TITLE SCREEN

HOW TO PLAY

GALACTIC CHESS INVADERS

← BACK

THE TWIST

A real chess game plays out – but Black's army is also a Space Invaders fleet. It slides sideways, drops down, and fires at you. You command White's moves and a laser ship at the bottom of the screen.

CONTROLS

← → / A D	Move your ship
SPACE	Fire laser
CLICK	Pick a piece, click a square to move
5s	Turn timer – stall and the CPU moves

HOW TO WIN

Clear the board: destroy every black piece by shooting it or capturing it in chess. Landing a shot on the black King ends the wave with a huge bonus.

STAY ALIVE

Guard your White King and your ship. You have 3 lives – lose one if a shot hits your ship or an invader reaches the bottom row.

SCORING

 500	 150
 75	 50
 50	 25

HISTORY

Galactic Chess Invaders began as a demo prototype in 1983 on the Apple II, written in TASC compiled BASIC. Now, with the help of Claude, you can experience a modern, recharged version.

ESC OR ← BACK TO RETURN

● YOU ● WHITE ● ENEMY ● BLACK

SCORE 000000

HI 012300

LEVEL 01



? INFO



5 s



GAMEPLAY - LEVEL 1 WAVE START

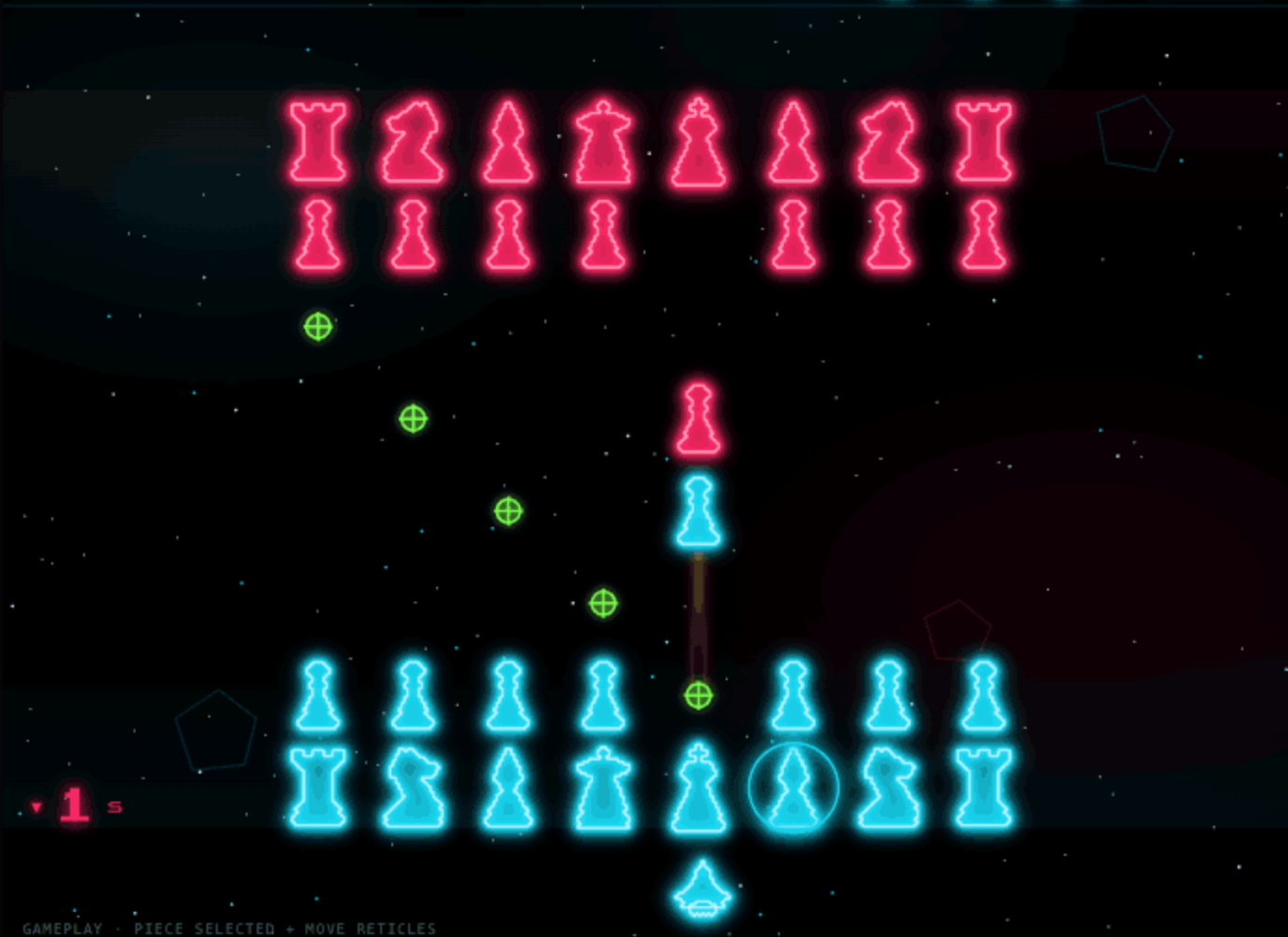
SCORE 001250

HI 012300

LEVEL 02



? INFO



SCORE 047250

HI 052300

LEVEL 03



INFO



GAME OVER

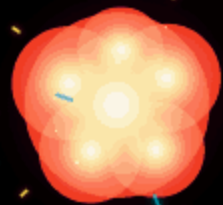
FINAL SCORE
047250

HI-SCORE
052300

LEVEL REACHED
03

PRESS FIRE TO PLAY AGAIN

ESC - MAIN MENU



GAME OVER

SPRITE SHEET

PIECES & SHIPS • NEON VECTOR • BLOOM IS A RENDER PASS, NOT BAKED

CHESS PIECES — WHITE (player) / BLACK (enemy)



Pawn

Knight

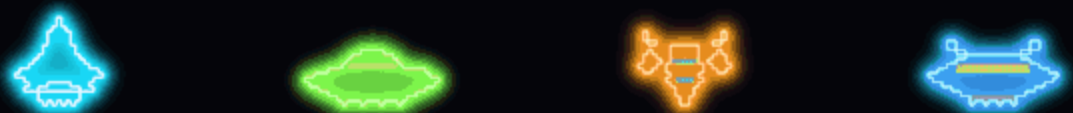
Bishop

Rook

Queen

King

SHIPS



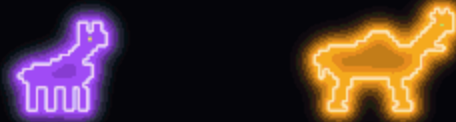
Player Fighter

Raider Scout

Galaxian Escort

Galaxian Flagship

BONUS SHIPS — JEFF MINTER TRIBUTE (flyover after Level 1)



Llama • 1000 pts

Mutant Camel • 2000 pts

DAMAGE & EXPLOSIONS

OUTLINE OMITTED AS THE PIECE TAKES HITS · ARCADE FIREBALLS

DAMAGE STATES — enemy queen



Full



Chipped

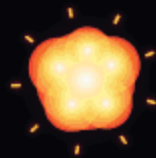


Cracked

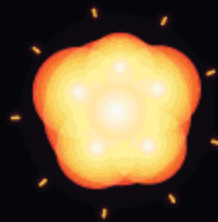


Critical

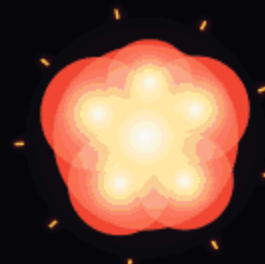
EXPLOSIONS



Small



Medium



Large



King